

Research Question Media has a long history of portraying gender in their stereotypical gender roles. Especially older blockbuster movies such as Indiana Jones (Schmidt 2022) portray the man (Dr. Jones) as fearless “tough guy” who gets what he wants. Women on the other hand are portrayed as love interest, hysterical, and afraid. This portrayal seems out of date, and movies today, albeit still not perfect in their gender representation, would be unlikely to release with such messages. But when did this change occur? Was the change gradual, or did some events/movements bring forward bigger leaps of change?

Body of Research To limit confounding factors, we have chosen to research gender representation within one long-running series: James Bond. The series first movie was released in 1962 and since then new movies were released in regular intervals. The movies within the series share the same genre, and with the small changes to cast, crew, and plot over the years, they are a great opportunity to observe development over a long period of time.

Prior Works There are already essays on the representation of women in the James Bond franchise. But they are either limited in scope, only regarding a subset of series (“How Portrayal of Women Has Changed in the Bond Girls | Free Essay Examples — Samples.freshessays.com”), or in detail lacking evidence to back up their claims (“Bond Girls: Then and Now – A Look at the Evolution of 007’s Leading Ladies — Vintageshowbiz.com”).

Dataset The corpus chosen consists of the James Bond 50th Anniversary DVD Collection. It was digitized as a private copy. Due to copyright restrictions, it will not be distributed with the codebase. But the code-base is corpus agnostic, so it is possible to run it with any other movies.

Methods The methods for this research consist of three main components (pipeline can be seen in figure 1):

1. **Scene detection:** splitting the movies into scenes and saving one frame per scene. Achieved with PySceneDetect (Castellano)
2. **Person detection** Which detects persons and their bounding boxes for each scene-frame. Achieved with YOLO (“Ultralytics — Pypi.org”)
3. **Traits detection** Which detects the gender and traits of a detected person. This is Achieved with CLIP (“GitHub - Openai/CLIP: CLIP (Contrastive Language-Image Pretraining), Predict the Most Relevant Text Snippet Given an Image — Github.com”)

Limitations Due to missing availability of the movie scripts, only visual features of the movies are taken into consideration. Information that is not visually apparent will thus not be considered in this study.

Additionally, while choosing only one movie series helps to reduce confounding factors, this limits generalizability. Changes in gender portrayal specific to James Bond, may not necessarily be indicative or a larger cultural shift.

Attachment

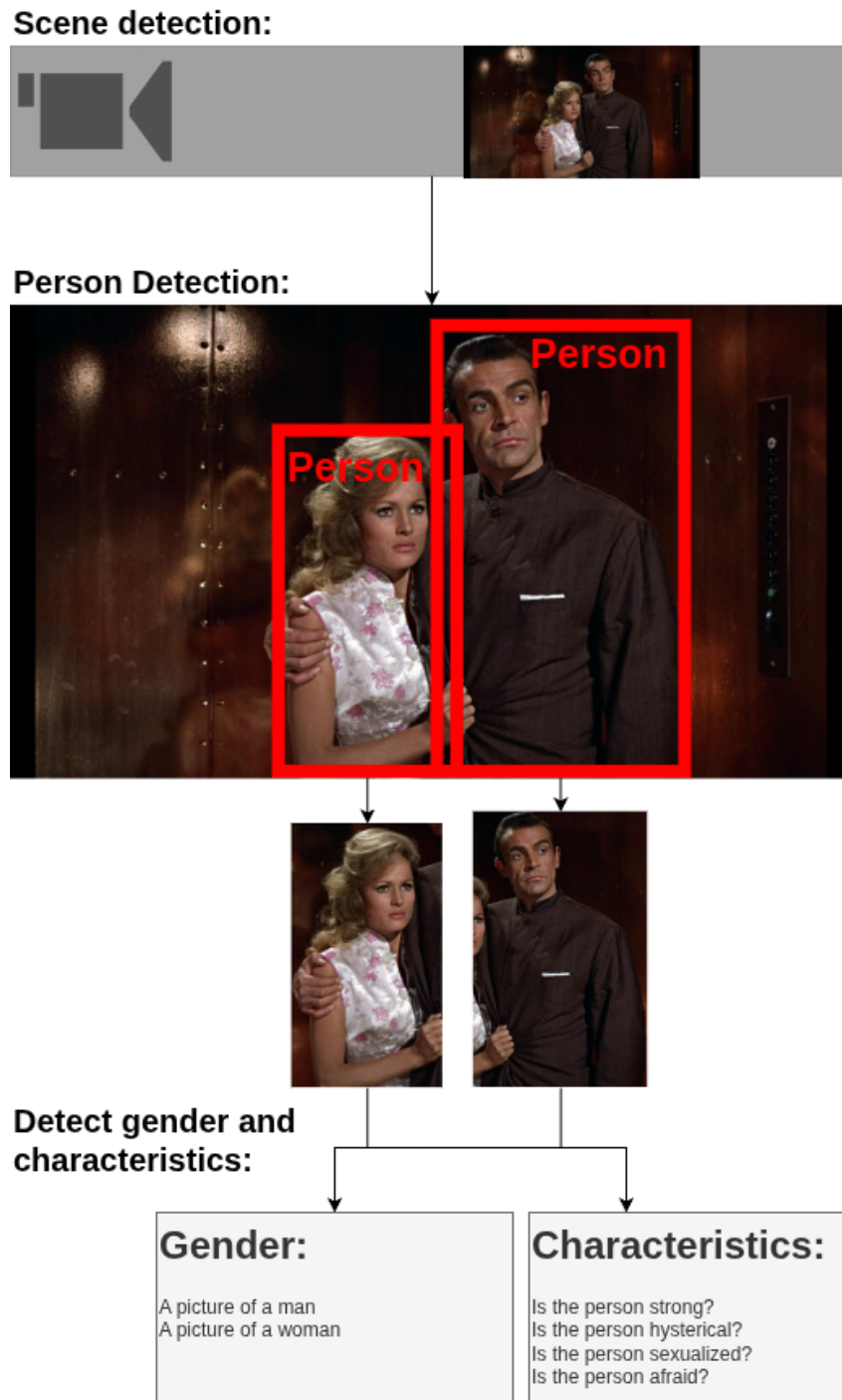


Figure 1: Data pipeline: Movie is split into scene-frames. Person detection is run for each scene-frame. Trait and gender prediction is run for each person detected in a scene-frame.

- “Bond Girls: Then and Now – A Look at the Evolution of 007’s Leading Ladies — Vintageshowbiz.com.” <https://vintageshowbiz.com/bond-girls-then-and-now/>.
- Castellano, Brandon. “Home - PySceneDetect — Scenedetect.com.” <https://www.scenedetect.com/>.
- “GitHub - Openai/CLIP: CLIP (Contrastive Language-Image Pretraining), Predict the Most Relevant Text Snippet Given an Image — Github.com.” <https://github.com/openai/CLIP>.
- “How Portrayal of Women Has Changed in the Bond Girls | Free Essay Examples — Samples.freshessays.com.” <https://samples.freshessays.com/how-portrayal-of-women-has-changed-in-the-bond-girls.html>.
- Schmidt, Kate C. S. 2022. “Feminism and Indiana Jones: A Field Guide.” *Indiana Jones and Philosophy*. Wiley. <https://doi.org/10.1002/9781119740186.ch5>.
- “Ultralytics — Pypi.org.” <https://pypi.org/project/ultralytics/>.